



INTERNAL SECURITY

MODULE - 19

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-BANGLADESH BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES



1 Instead of following natural barriers, the borders meander through villages, agricultural lands and rivers, rendering the border extremely porous with many disputed pockets.

2 Undermarked stretches, existence of enclaves (chhitmahals), and adverse possessions are cause of constant friction between the border guarding forces of India and Bangladesh.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-BANGLADESH BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES

**3**

The Indira-Mujibur Agreement laid down the methods for demarcating various disputed stretches of the India-Bangladesh boundary.

4

Porous border, lack of economic opportunities, poverty and underdevelopment, attitude of the people towards petty crimes, laxity in vigilance, alleged nexus between criminals and police and border guarding forces all contribute to the escalating trans-border crimes.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-BANGLADESH BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES

- 5 Smuggling of cattle has become a serious concern.
- 6 Truckloads of cattle from Haryana, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh are shipped to the India-Bangladesh border everyday, ostensibly for grazing purposes.
- 7 From here, these cattle are smuggled into Bangladesh.
- 8 The Border Security Force (BSF) regularly seizes cattle. Along with cattle, smuggling of arms and other essential items, such as sugar, salt and diesel, human and narcotics trafficking, counterfeit Indian currency, Kidnapping, and thefts are quite common along this border.



BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-BANGLADESH BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY AGREEMENT (LBA)

Context:

More than four years after the historic Land Boundary Agreement (LBA) between India and Bangladesh, a report released by civil rights organisations on the situation in erstwhile enclaves states that protest and resistance have become an essential part of their survival in India.

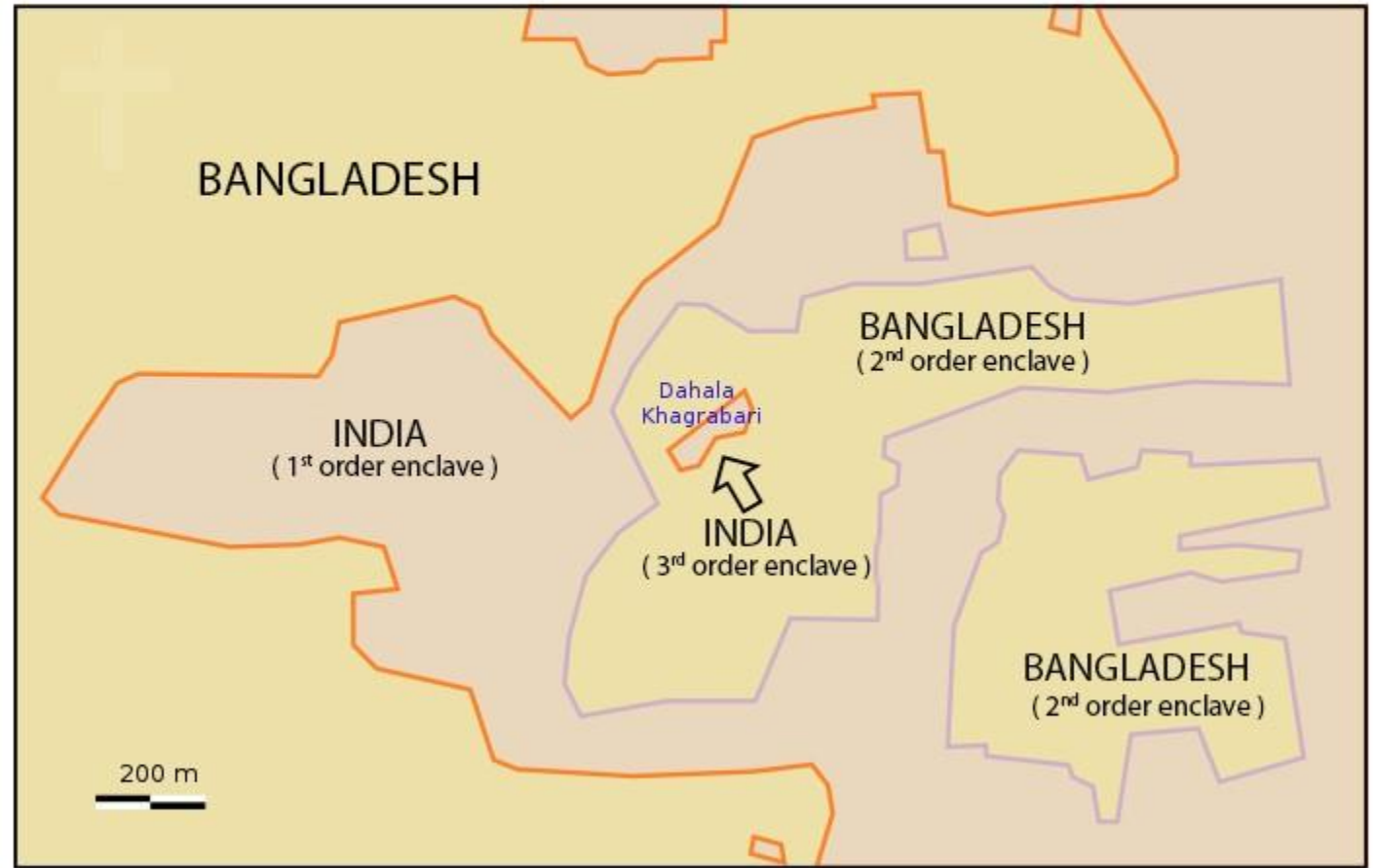
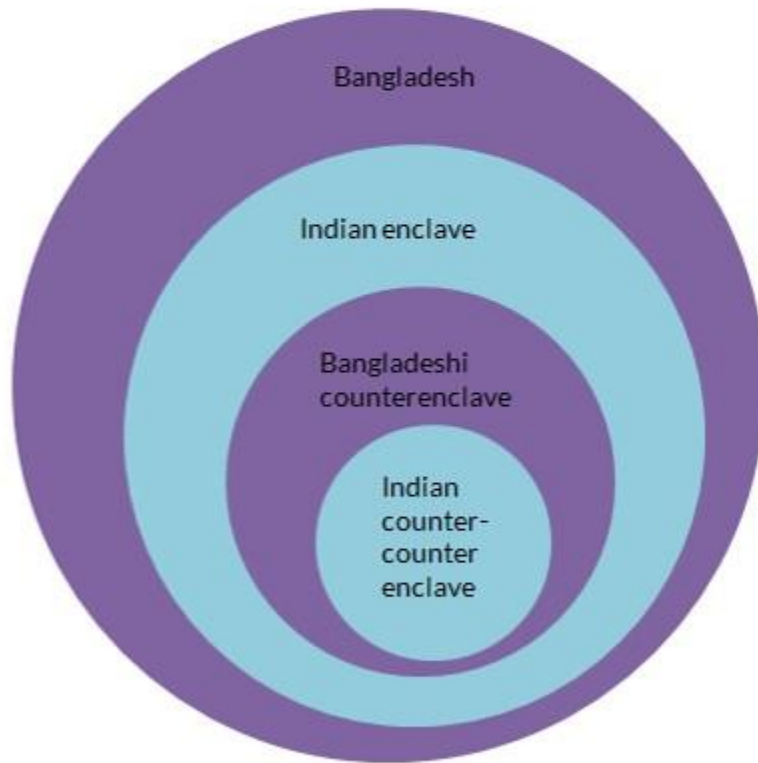


What's the issue now?

- The situation has not improved. There are marked continuities in the problems that existed in the pre-LBA years, although the nature and context of the problems have perceptibly changed.
- On India's part, the spotlight has now shifted from the identity crisis faced by erstwhile enclave dwellers in the pre-LBA situation, to issues of poor governance, as well as conflict of interest between the Centre and the state in the post-LBA years.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-BANGLADESH BORDER



BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-BANGLADESH BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY AGREEMENT (LBA)

What are the concerns?

The intractable discord regarding the implementation of the measures as promised to the new citizens, coupled with lack of coordination between the Centre and the state in India, has apparently transformed the enclaves into hotbeds of local politics.



About The Land Boundary Agreement:

- Under the Land Boundary Agreement, the Bangladeshi enclaves in India and Indian enclaves in Bangladesh were transferred on July 31, 2015.
- The agreement involved handing over 17,000 acres of land to Bangladesh in return for 7,000 acres in 162 enclaves in West Bengal, Assam, Tripura and Meghalaya.
- It also required an amendment to the Constitution (the 119th amendment).

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDIA-SRI LANKA



MARITIME ISSUES

- 1** The proximity results in the encroachment into each other's territory by fishermen unknowingly resulting into arrests/ detention, attacks.
- 2** In 1974, India agreed to Sri Lanka's sovereignty over a small barren island in the Palk bay area, named "Katchatheevu" with some safeguards to Indian fishermen.
- 3** However, the Sri Lankan government argues against the fishing rights of Indian fishermen in these waters where they have been fishing traditionally.
- 4** The grant of "Katchatheevu" has endangered the Indian fishermen's right over the rich fishing waters.
- 5** Whenever, Indian folks stray into the Sri Lankan waters around the island, it leads to skirmishes and incidents.



BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-CHINA BORDER

CHALLENGES

- Border dispute at Aksai Chin, Arunachal Pradesh with occasional aggression
- Smuggling of Chinese consumer goods
- Inadequate infrastructure for surveillance due to difficult terrain
- Presence of multiple forces along the border as opposed to single PLA
- Water sharing issue.



RECENT INITIATIVES

- Construction of some critical bridges to cut down time for troop movement such as Dhola-Sadiya bridge.
- India has joined hands with Japan to aggressively develop infrastructure projects in North east to contain China.
- Army infrastructure projects within 100km of LAC have been exempted from forest clearance.
- To expedite border road construction, Ministry of Defence has decided to delegate administrative and financial powers to the Border Roads Organisation (BRO).

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-PAKISTAN BORDER

CHALLENGES

- Border dispute at Sir Creek and Kashmir.
- River water sharing issue at Indus river.
- Infiltration and Cross-border terrorism targeted to destabilise India.
- Diverse terrain including desert, marshes, snow capped mountain and plains makes border guarding difficult.
- Time & cost overruns in infrastructure projects due to unforeseen circumstances & natural calamities.
- Other issues include drug smuggling, fake currency, arms trafficking.

RECENT INITIATIVES

- Comprehensive Integrated Border Management System (CIBMS) to establish an integrated security system at borders providing all-round security even in adverse climatic conditions.
- The Centre also thought of deploying Indian special forces unit National Security Guard (NSG) commandos in J&K to fortify counter terror operations by training J&K police and other paramilitary forces in room intervention, anti-terror skills, overseeing anti-hijack operations etc.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-NEPAL BORDER

CHALLENGES

- Increasing extremism and anti-India activities due to increasing activities of ISI such as pushing in men and explosives through the border.
- Fear of spread of Maoist insurgency due to links of Nepal's Maoists in India.
- Insurgents, terrorists, many hard-core criminals pursued by Indian and Nepalese security forces escape across the open border.

RECENT INITIATIVES

- Establishment of a new intelligence section in SSB at Indo-Nepal and Indo- Bhutan border to ensure better operational efficiency.
- Establishment of Border District Coordination Committee at the level of district officials of the two countries to discuss issues of mutual concern.
- The Government of India has approved construction of 1377 km of roads along Nepal border.
- Development aid to Nepal to prevent human trafficking owing to lack of employment opportunities there.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-BHUTAN BORDER

CHALLENGES

- Many groups such as Bodo, ULFA etc. sneak into Bhutan for sanctuary despite the army driving them out.
- Smuggling of goods such as Bhutanese cannabis, liquor and forest products.
- Free movement of people and vehicle leading to issues such as during the Gorkhaland movement in West Bengal.



RECENT INITIATIVES

- A Secretary level bilateral mechanism in the shape of an India-Bhutan Group on Border Management and Security.
- Cooperation with their army to prevent sanctuary to insurgents in their soil.
- Establishing new border posts in Sikkim along the Bhutan frontier near Doklam.
- The Union environment ministry has given a “general approval” for the diversion of forest land for major border infrastructure projects along the eastern border with Bhutan, Myanmar and Nepal.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-MYANMAR BORDER

CHALLENGES

- Free movement Regime: Insurgents are misusing FMR to cross-over to Myanmar and receive training and acquire arms.
- Drug trafficking due to proximity to golden triangle.
- Weak borders as there is practically no physical barrier along the border either in the form of fences or border outposts and roads to ensure strict vigil.
- Poor Infrastructural facilities at Moreh and Zokhawatar – the two designated points for normal trade and border trade.

RECENT INITIATIVES

- Cabinet proposed to set up 13 new Integrated Check Posts (ICPs) to encourage India's engagement with SAARC countries along with Thailand and Myanmar.
- ICP is able to interdict such elements while facilitating legitimate trade and commerce.



BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-BANGLADESH BORDER

CHALLENGES

- Water disputes such as sharing of Teesta river, construction of Dam by India on Barak river.
- Illegal migration: Since the 1971 war of independence that created the state of Bangladesh, millions of Bangladeshi immigrants (the vast majority of them illegal) have poured into India.
- Inadequate border fencing due to issues such as riverine areas, protests by residing population, pending land acquisition etc.
- Trafficking of goods like jamdani sarees, rice salt etc. as well as cattle smuggling.

RECENT INITIATIVES

- Government has announced the establishment of Border Protection Grid (BPG) with Indo- Bangladesh Border States.
- A crime-free stretch has been established between the BSF border posts at Gunarmath and Kalyani and the BGB (Border Guards Bangladesh) border posts at Putkhali and Daulatpur.
- Installation of Border surveillance devices such as closed-circuit cameras, searchlights, thermal imaging devices and drones to keep a tight vigil.
- The BSF and BGB have also been raising awareness among the locals regarding crime prevention in the border area.



8 Raising the issues of infiltration from across the border during various meeting with counterpart countries.

7 Up-gradation of intelligence network and co-ordination with sister agencies, conduct of special operations along the border.

6 Advances in surveillance technology can help to maintain a constant vigil

5 Accelerated development of infrastructure along the border, especially to wean the border population from illegal activities.



STEPS REQUIRED TO ENSURE BORDER SECURITY

1 Resolving pending border disputes soon as they later become matters of national security threat.

2 No diversion of security forces

3 Responsibility for unsettled and disputed borders, such as the LoC in J&K and the LAC on the Indo-Tibetan border, should be that of the Indian Army

4 Follow one-force-one-border principle



BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

WHAT DO YOU UNDERSTAND BY COMPREHENSIVE INTEGRATED BORDER MANAGEMENT SYSTEM (CIBMS)?



- 1 It is a robust and integrated system that is capable of addressing the gaps in the present system of border security by seamlessly integrating human resources, weapons, and high-tech surveillance equipment.

2

It has three main components:

- ✓ **New high-tech surveillance** devices such as sensors, detectors, cameras, etc. as well as existing equipment for round-the-clock surveillance of the international border.
- ✓ An **efficient and dedicated communication network** including fiber optic cables and satellite communication for transmitting data gathered;
- ✓ A **command and control centre** to which the data will be transmitted providing a composite picture of the international border.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

WHAT DO YOU UNDERSTAND BY COMPREHENSIVE INTEGRATED BORDER MANAGEMENT SYSTEM (CIBMS)?



3 Smart fencing at the borders under CIBMS is a technological solution devised to address the security issues in the Border States.

4 BOLD-QIT (Border Electronically Dominated QRT Interception Technique) under CIBMS is the project to install technical systems under the CIBMS, which enables BSF to equip Indo-Bangla borders with different kind of sensors in unfenced riverine area of Brahmaputra and its tributaries.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

ROLE OF TECHNOLOGY IN BORDER MANAGEMENT



- 1 Upgrading existing system:** Technology can be integrated with the existing systems to facilitate better detection and interception by the man behind the machine.

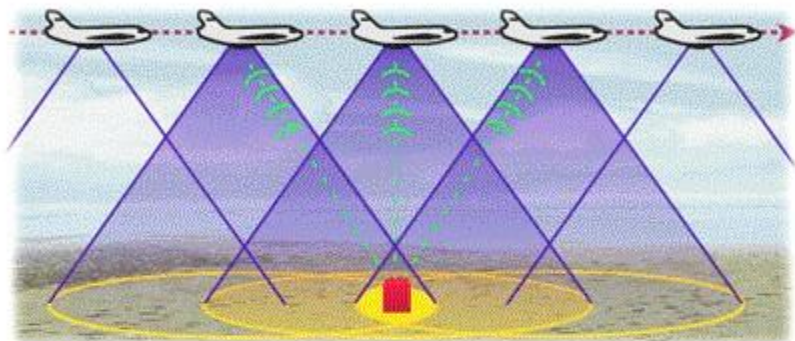
- 2 Checking infiltration:** It can be help to detect infiltration via land, underwater, air and tunnels by deploying close-circuit television cameras, thermal imagers and night vision devices etc.

- 3 Facilitate Communication:** It can be used for better coordination among various stakeholders by providing timely information.

- ✓ E.g. 1: Deployment of CAPFs in remote areas can be coordinated through satellite communications.
- ✓ E.g. 2: Deployment of dedicated communication satellites like GSAT 7, GSAT 7A and Cartosat satellites.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

ROLE OF TECHNOLOGY IN BORDER MANAGEMENT

**4**

Improved Intelligence inputs and Surveillance:

- Through Remote sensing satellites, radar satellites and satellites with synthetic aperture radar (SAR) sensors which are capable of providing day and night all-terrain and all-weather inputs.
- Facilitate Navigation: Indian Regional Navigation Satellite System (IRNSS)-based GPS will provide navigation facilities for operational parties in high altitude, remote and difficult borders, and Maoist-affected areas.

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